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IAF to get 97 Tejas jets

New Delhi, Sept. 25: The defence ministry on Thursday signed a ₹62,370-crore deal with the state-owned Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL) for procurement of 97 Tejas Mk 1A light combat aircraft (LCA) for the Indian Air Force (IAF). The deal includes 68 fighters and 29 twin seaters. Delivery starts 2027, completes six years.

Rail launcher for Agni test

New Delhi, Sept. 25: India successfully test-fired the 2,000 km range Agni-Prime missile from a rail-based mobile launcher, demonstrating nationwide deployment capability. Defence Minister Rajnath Singh said this achievement places India among select nations with advanced rail-mobile missile launch systems and strategic readiness.

■ Full report on page 10

Jagapathi grilled by ED

Hyderabad, Sept. 25: Suspecting veteran Tollywood actor Jagapathi Babu's alleged financial involvement with the scam-ridden Sahiti Infra, officials from the Enforcement Directorate (ED) questioned the actor on Thursday for four hours. The agency traced money transactions between Jagapathi Babu, Sandu Purnachandra Rao.

■ Full report on page 4

TG to take over Metro, L&T quits

L VENKAT RAM REDDY | DC HYDERABAD, SEPT. 25

The state government on Thursday decided to take over the Hyderabad Metro Rail Phase-1 project from Larsen & Toubro (L&T), paving the way for faster execution of Phase-2. The decision, finalised at a high-level meeting chaired by Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy, marks a significant shift in Hyderabad's urban transport strategy.

As part of the agreement, the state will absorb nearly ₹13,000 crore of outstanding debt of L&T Metro Rail Hyderabad Ltd (LTMRL) and make a one-time settlement of ₹2,000 crore towards its equity investment.

This will give the government complete ownership of Phase-1 and enable smoother clearance and implementation of the proposed Phase-2A and Phase-2B expansions. The move follows repeated objections from the Union

Breakfast in schools from '26: Revanth

DC CORRESPONDENT HYDERABAD, SEPT. 25

Chief Minister A. Revanth Reddy on Thursday announced that the Telangana government will launch the 'Chief Minister's Breakfast Scheme' for schoolchildren in government schools starting from the 2026-27 academic year, drawing inspiration from Tamil Nadu's pioneering initiative.

■ Full report on page 7

government, which had insisted on operational integration between Phase-1 and built under public-private partnership (PPP) model and the state-led Phase-2 network.

■ Page 7: TG to pay ₹2K cr to L&T towards equity investment



Narendra Modi

Congress era brought heavy taxes, loot: Modi

DC CORRESPONDENT NEW DELHI, BANSWARA, SEPT. 25

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday lashed out at the Congress and other Opposition parties for misleading people on GST rate cuts and countered their narrative by citing examples of reduced prices of items ranging from toothpaste to tractors. Modi also asserted that during Congress-led governments, there was "tax loot" and people were "burdened with heavy taxes."

Speaking after inaugurating the UP International Trade Show (UP-ITS) in Greater Noida, the Prime Minister said that India stands firmly with its industries, traders, and citizens, driven by the commitment to "Reform, Perform and Transform".

The Prime Minister stated that just three days ago, next-generation GST reforms were implemented and described them as "structural changes that will propel India's growth story".

■ Page 10: PM: GST reforms ease taxes, aid MSMEs

Wangchuk-led NGO loses FCRA licence

New Delhi, Sept. 25: The Union home ministry on Thursday cancelled the Foreign Contribution Regulation Act licence of Students' Educational and Cultural Movement of Ladakh, founded by climate activist Sonam Wangchuk, with "immediate effect". The government has blamed Wangchuk for

the mob violence. However, Wangchuk roared that the Centre was trying to make him a scapegoat, rather than addressing the core of the problem. Forces detained at least 59 persons and imposed a strict curfew in Leh and its neighbourhood.

■ Full report on page 10

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